

Spring 2025 GA Summary Notes
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My work from January to April of this GA term is summarized and analyzed in my [Literature Review Draft](#). After receiving feedback on the literature review, I edited and expanded the schema drafted in the final section to include the terms ‘allocative: resulting in resources being withheld from certain groups’ and ‘denigrating: language which demeans/disrespects certain groups’. Using the new [Schema Draft](#), I then annotated 1.5 of three randomly selected 2025 federal bills from [translegislation.com](https://www.translegislation.com). My hypothesis of what text would show up in the bills that would correspond with our chosen terms is in the last column of the Schema Draft.

The thought process behind this was that once the schema keywords were associated with specific text strings from the bills these could be used in spaCy with named entity recognition to automate the labeling and identifying of ideologies within the whole sample of federal (and potentially state) bills. Eventually this could also be used on text from trans-affirming bills and/or activism with the hypothesis of identifying similar motivations of austerity and neo-capitalism, as theorized in Wren Ariel Gould’s [‘Coconstructing \(Trans-\)Capitalist Realism: Trans Activisms Collude in the Political Economy Structuring Anti-Trans Laws’](#).

At this point I had a [Terms First Draft](#), where I had directly copied and pasted relevant text strings for each term. Because the end goal is to feed the text into a machine, which I have limited experience with, I met with the other assistant, Michaela, who handled the ‘technical’ (i.e. LLM) aspects of the project, to get feedback on the ‘machine-readability’ of what I’d copied so far. Michaela guided me through her process of editing the first draft’s second column to be better suited for NER. At the end of this process we had [Terms Draft Two](#).

My final step of the semester was to complete the second half of schema annotations for the three selected bills, with better knowledge of formatting the text for machine-readability, resulting in [Terms Draft Three](#). The three annotated, color-coded bills can be found at the following links: [H.R. 1015](#), [H.R. 2617](#), [H. RES. 224](#).